CAPSTONE PROJECT REPORT

(Project Term January–May 2026)

FIND YOUR PRODUCT (FYP)

Location-Based Local Product Discovery Platform

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Project Group Number: 2RGC0121

Course Code: CSE439

Under the Guidance of

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School of Computer Science and Engineering

Lovely Professional University, Punjab

Academic Year: 2025–2026

TOPIC APPROVAL PERFORMA

School of Computer Science and Engineering

Program: P132::B.Tech. (Computer Science and Engineering)

COURSE CODE: CSE439 **REGULAR/BACKLOG :** Regular **GROUP NUMBER:** 2RGC0121

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PROPOSED TOPIC : Find Your Product (FYP) – Location-Based Local Product Discovery Platform

Qualitative Assessment of Proposed Topic by PAC		
Sr.No.	**Parameter**	**Rating (out of 10)**
1	Project Novelty: Potential of the project to create new knowledge	6.75
2	Project Feasibility: Project can be timely carried out in-house with low-cost and available resources in the University by the students.	6.75
3	Project Academic Inputs: Project topic is relevant and makes extensive use of academic inputs in UG program and serves as a culminating effort for core study area of the degree program.	7.50
4	Project Supervision: Project supervisor's is technically competent to guide students, resolve any issues, and impart necessary skills.	7.50
5	Social Applicability: Project work intends to solve a practical problem.	7.50
6	Future Scope: Project has potential to become basis of future research work, publication or patent.	6.75

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Final Topic Approved by PAC: **Find Your Product (FYP) – Location-Based Local Product Discovery Platform**

Overall Remarks: Approved

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DECLARATION

We hereby declare that the project work entitled "Find Your Product (FYP) — Location-Based Local Product Discovery Platform" is an authentic record of our own work carried out as a requirement of the Capstone Project for the award of B.Tech degree in Computer Science / Data Science from Lovely Professional University, under the guidance of Dr. Harpreet Kaur during January to May 2026. All information furnished in this capstone project report is based on our own intensive work and is genuine. No part of this work has been submitted elsewhere for any other degree or diploma.

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the declaration statement made by this group of students is correct to the best of my knowledge and belief. They have completed this Capstone Project under my guidance and supervision. The present work is the result of their original investigation, effort, and study. No part of the work has ever been submitted for any other degree at any university. The Capstone Project is fit for submission and partial fulfilment of the conditions for the award of B.Tech Degree in Computer Science / Data Science from Lovely Professional University, Punjab.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The successful completion of this project would not have been possible without the invaluable guidance, support, and encouragement of numerous individuals. We take this opportunity to express our sincere gratitude to all those who contributed, directly or indirectly, to the realization of this work.

We are deeply grateful to our project supervisor, Dr. Harpreet Kaur whose expert guidance, constructive criticism, and unwavering support throughout the development lifecycle were instrumental in shaping both the technical depth and academic quality of this project. Their mentorship extended beyond technical matters, instilling in us the values of rigorous inquiry and systematic problem solving.

We extend our heartfelt appreciation to the faculty members of the Department of Computer Science for their encouragement and for providing access to necessary resources and infrastructure. The broader academic environment at Lovely Professional University has been a constant source of intellectual stimulation.

We also acknowledge the open-source communities behind React, Node.js, MongoDB, Tailwind CSS, and Leaflet, whose exceptional tools and documentation formed the technical backbone of this platform. Additionally, we thank our peers and classmates who participated in user acceptance testing and provided candid feedback that significantly improved the user experience.

Finally, we owe a debt of gratitude to our families for their unconditional support, patience, and motivation throughout this academic journey.

Shaik Mohammed Adeeb
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1. INTRODUCTION

In today's world, digital innovation has changed how we think about our role as consumers, and it has also changed how businesses function globally. At the same time that larger-scale e-commerce sites have been able to link consumers to international suppliers, there has emerged an ironic divide; local vendors who represent the heart of neighborhood-based economies have generally remained unconnected to the digital commerce space. This divide is most evident in the semi-urban and urban areas throughout developing countries. In these areas, individual retailers often exist without access to the necessary digital tools to inform their potential buyers regarding the status of available merchandise (pricing, inventory), and/or the retailer's exact location in real time.

Find Your Product (FYP) bridges this existing gap by establishing a new type of location aware product discovery solution specifically designed to assist customers seeking information about the availability of particular products at locations near them. Once a customer locates a desired product, he/she will be provided with pertinent business information including the current market price for that item, whether the vendor currently possesses that item, and the exact address of the vendor. The system will provide vendors with an intelligent inventory management tool which can alert vendors when they run out of an item, and/ or when they experience increased demand for an item.

Technically, FYP was built as a full stack web application utilizing a three tiered client server structure. The front end was created utilizing React.js and Tailwind CSS, creating a highly responsive and intuitive user interface. The back-end of the application utilizes Node.js and Express.js, providing a robust RESTful API layer. FYP utilizes MongoDB as its primary data storage mechanism due to its flexible document based architecture which lends itself well to the varied product and vendor data sets found within a multivendor marketplace. FYP uses Leaflet, a JavaScript mapping library, and geolocation APIs to implement geospatial capabilities.

This report represents a complete examination of the FYP platform. It covers the problem context, requirements gathering, system design, implementation plan, test plans and projected path of development for FYP.

2. PROFILE OF THE PROBLEM, RATIONALE & SCOPE OF THE STUDY

2.1 Profile of the Problem

The local retail community currently functions as an extremely disorganised and manual product discovery system. Local retailers exist all over the world but there is no central source that offers real-time access to each vendor's inventory. Therefore, customers seeking products in local retail environments often have to physically explore a neighborhood to find what they want; utilize some form of memory (personal or otherwise); use social media and/or other forms of informal networking; or visit individual storefronts repeatedly until a desired item is found. None of these methods can be classified as either time-efficient or scalable.

The following structural shortcomings were found by observing and analyzing current local commerce systems:

1. Lack of Product Availability Information: Consumers generally do not know which stores in close proximity carry the products they seek at any particular time. As such, they have to make repeated trips to multiple stores before finding the items they are looking for.

2. Time Consuming Search Process: The above described search process requires considerable amounts of consumer time and energy. There is little assurance that the time will result in a successful purchase at any one store.

3. No Comparative Pricing Mechanisms: Since there are no means of price comparison available, consumers cannot make informed purchasing decisions based upon prices charged locally.

4. Limited Vendor Access to Customers: Smaller retailers primarily acquire new customers via foot traffic in front of their shops. These small businesses have very limited ability to reach their target audience using digital marketing techniques or branding efforts.

5. Inefficient Stock Control Systems: Most small vendors utilize inefficient or manual processes for managing inventory levels. They lack the tools required to effectively forecast future demand or optimize their inventory levels.

6. Absent Demand Data: Retailers lack an organized method of determining which products are in high demand throughout their service region.

7. No Structured Communication Mechanism: Prior to visiting a retailer, there is no formalized communication pathway for the retailer and the prospective customer. This leads to unnecessary travel by both parties, and lost business opportunities.

All of the previously discussed structural shortfalls clearly indicate the urgent necessity for creating a smart, location aware, real-time product discovery tool designed to integrate local commerce into a single unified digital marketplace.

2.2 Rationale

From an intellectual point of view, this project's primary purpose is to improve the operational effectiveness and business profitability of local retail commerce by developing a digital intermediary platform which will link consumers directly to vendors within their area in an efficient and intelligent way. Global e-commerce sites have been successful in building large-scale virtual stores. However, there architecture is based primarily on the warehouse-to-consumer supply chain model as opposed to enabling instant, localized purchasing at a customer's current location.

This difference presents two opportunities, a marketplace need and a research opportunity.

The FYP platform is based upon the notion that local, immediate product discovery offers unique value propositions which are not offered by present platforms; i.e., immediacy of availability (product available today) and accessible by walking or driving within minutes, supporting local economic development, eliminating delays associated with deliveries. The FYP Platform provides solutions to each of the above

issues using real time product search, location-based vendor suggestions, real time inventory notifications, and commercially viable insights derived from data.

2.3 Scope of the Study

The range of the FYP project includes designing, developing, and validating an entire full stack web based system that serves as a platform for different types of users. These different types of users are categorized into the following functions:

User (customer)

- Location-based product searches on a live basis.
- Find nearby vendors, and see what products they have available.
- Compare prices and filter by product type cross-vendor.
- Use interactive maps to find out where each vendor is located.
- Request a product that is not currently in stock.

Vendor

- Manage all products (add, edit, delete).
- Track real time stock levels with automatic notification when stock reaches a certain low point.
- Demand signal notifications to the vendor related to how often customers search for those products.
- Analyze local product demand trends using analytical dashboards.

System

- Real time synchronization of inventory data across the entire platform.
- GPS/Ip geo location filtering so you can't buy something if it's not near your current or Ip location.
- Role based access control for customers, vendors, administrators

2.4 Problem Statement

A significant failure in the ability to effectively discover products on a timely basis exists in the current local retail environment. Retail customers do not have the opportunity to find local retailers who carry the products they need until they physically search for them. Local retailers also do not possess the necessary technology to efficiently communicate their product availability, make informed decisions regarding how much stock to hold at each store, nor be able to assess and react to dynamic market demand. The FYP platform will address this two-way information gap by establishing a real-time, geographically-based local product discovery platform connecting buyers and sellers locally; increase transparency into all aspects of commerce; provide vendors with decision-making tools based on intelligent inventory management and analysis of demand trends.

3. EXISTING SYSTEM

3.1 Introduction

The current ways for people to find local items are based on time-consuming, person-to-person (unmediated) approaches. There is no central place for all of the consumers and local businesses to be able to share product information. As such, the way that consumers and local vendors exchange product related information is generally slow, skewed towards one party (the consumer), and heavily influenced by how close each side is physically or socially connected. Most often consumers will use a combination of going into stores themselves, relying on their own experience about what products are available from previous visits, and/or asking other people who may know where certain products can be found as the primary method of finding out if there are specific products available. Conversely, most vendors have very little choice but to rely on people coming into their stores, possibly some basic advertising in the local community and virtually nothing else to tell potential customers when they have new stock of something specific.

3.2 Existing Software Analysis

The following platforms represent the most relevant existing solutions and serve as the comparative baseline for evaluating the novelty and utility of the FYP system:

3.2.1 Google Maps

Google Maps allows users to find local businesses with similar attributes and will also help navigate to these places along with some of their operational hours and general information about them. But, the service doesn't allow you to search for products at specific stores; nor does it offer any real time inventory updates or price comparisons. Therefore, its role is that of a business locator versus an item discovery.

3.2.2 Amazon / Flipkart

These e-commerce websites offer a level of detail in searching for products; comparing prices; and reviewing the quality of products by consumers. While they have well-developed logistics systems that include centralized warehouses, and distribution networks to facilitate the transportation of goods from those warehouses to customers,

they do not possess the ability to reflect the real time inventory levels of nearby retailers, nor can they enable customers to pick up goods locally immediately (same day) unless they make an advance appointment with a retailer.

3.2.3 Justdial

Justdial helps people find out who can provide them with what services at a local level. It does allow you to look up by service categories; however it will not help you if you want to do product searches. In addition, there are no inventory or price information available on this website. The usefulness of JustDial is mostly in finding where to contact businesses as opposed to discovering whether an item is currently available.

3.2.4 Point-of-Sale (POS) and Inventory Management Systems

There are many different types of Inventory Management Systems (IMS) that companies use internally to track their own inventory. However, IMSs have no interface to the customer facing side of the world. Therefore, IMSs cannot be accessed publicly, have no means to help consumers discover them based upon a specific location and also cannot inform potential buyers about availability of products they may be interested in purchasing.

3.3 Data Flow Diagram: Existing System

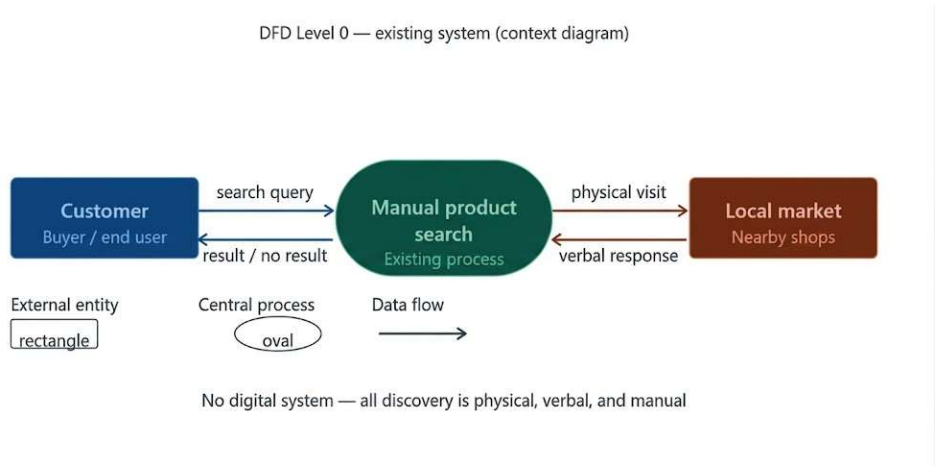

Figure 3.1: Context Diagram (Level 0) — Existing Manual Product Discovery Process

The current model for consumers is that they visit in-person to a retail outlet to inquire as to whether a particular item is available. If it is unavailable, the consumer will

continue this inquiry process at other retail outlets until successful. Additionally, price comparisons are made by the consumer on an informal and memorized basis.

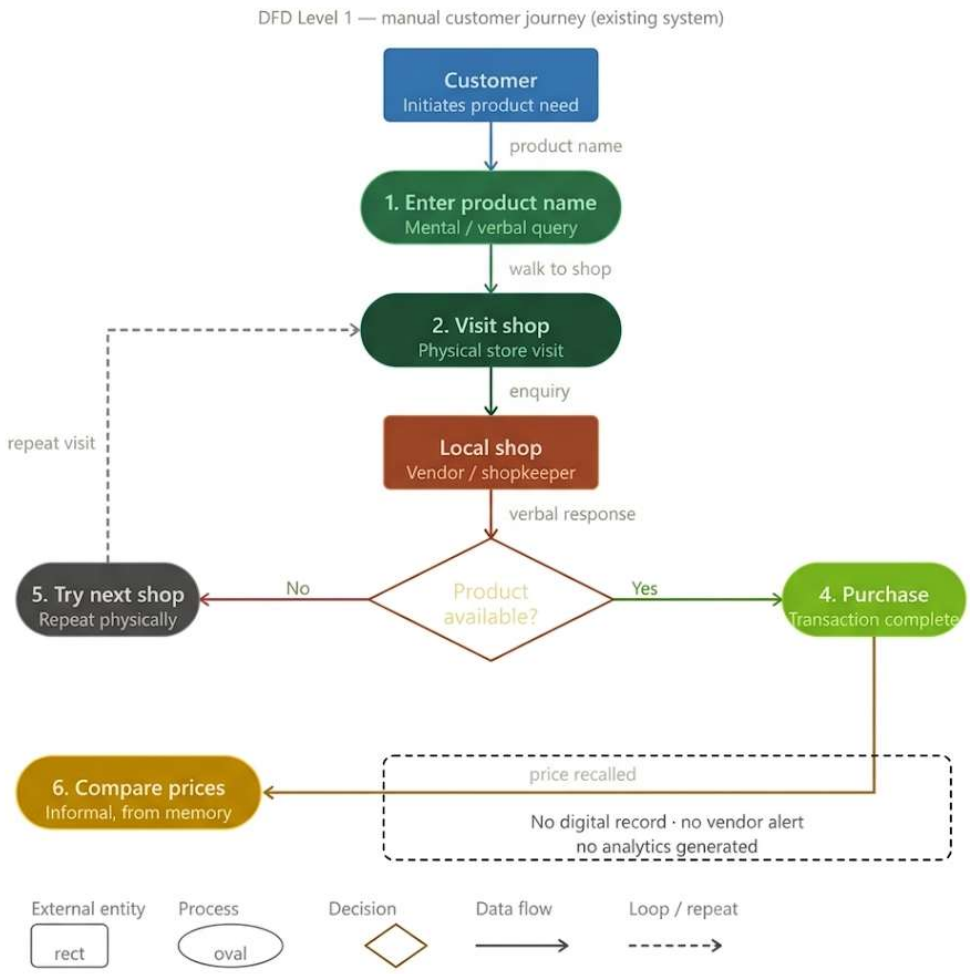

Figure 3.2: Detailed Flow (Level 1) — Manual Customer Journey

3.4 Innovations in the Proposed FYP System

The FYP system introduces a suite of targeted innovations that collectively transform the local product discovery process from a manual, inefficient exercise into a streamlined digital experience. A comparative evaluation of the existing and proposed systems is presented below:

Table 3.1: Comparative Analysis — Existing System vs. Proposed FYP Platform

Feature	Existing System	FYP Platform
Product Search	Manual (physical)	Digital + Location-based
Inventory Visibility	Not Available	Real-time
Price Comparison	Manual / Memory	Automated & Displayed
Vendor Digital Reach	Foot traffic only	Platform-wide visibility
Vendor Notifications	None	Smart alerts (stock/demand)
Demand Analytics	None	Dashboard-based insights
Customer Experience	Time-consuming, uncertain	Efficient, transparent, fast

4. PROBLEM ANALYSIS

4.1 Product Definition

This is a geospatial based local product discovery system called Find Your Product (FYP). The system was created to solve the information asymmetry problem that exists when consumers have no way of knowing where to find locally made products in their area; however, these products' producers already know exactly what they produce and are typically located within close proximity to the consumer's desired purchase location.

As such, this application will utilize a client server architecture utilizing geolocation technology, a real time inventory management system as well as a multiple user role based access control mechanism and intelligent notification system all integrated into one single scalable web interface.
The core value proposition of the FYP System is the removal of the physical search process required by consumers today who desire to shop at local businesses. As stated above, the platform enables the consumer to query the platform for a particular product and then be presented with a list of vendors that possess the requested item, listed in order from closest geographic location to farthest. This list includes pricing information for each vendor's product offering as well as confirmation of the vendor's current availability of said product. In short, the FYP System provides consumers a significantly better experience than they receive today while providing vendors with increased exposure, automated tracking of customer demands, and proactive management capabilities related to their inventory.

Table 4.1: Key Components of the FYP Platform

Component	Description
User Interface	Responsive web interface for product search, vendor browsing, and map navigation
Location Engine	GPS/IP-based geolocation for identifying and ranking nearby vendors
Inventory System	Real-time stock management enabling dynamic vendor-side updates
Notification Module	Threshold-based alerts for low stock, high demand, and customer requests
Search & Ranking Engine	Matches user queries with nearby product availability, sorted by distance and price
Database System	MongoDB collections for users, vendors, products, inventory, and transactions

4.2 Feasibility Analysis

A multidimensional feasibility evaluation was performed in order to assess the practical feasibility of the proposed system prior to committing resources for further development

4.2.1 Technical Feasibility

The proposed system is technologically feasible due to the maturation of technologies that were selected. The chosen combination of React.js, Node.js, Express.js, and MongoDB constitutes a well documented and widely used set of tools which have an active community supporting them.

Geolocation will be successfully implemented using both the browser geolocation API and the leaflet mapping tool. Authentication/Authorization can be performed using the JWT standard as well as one time password (OTP) verification via email. Both methods are well-established methods for providing security in web applications.

The primary technological obstacle — maintaining accurate inventory data in real time while concurrently updating inventory information from vendors — can be solved using the atomic update features of MongoDB and reactive front-end state management using TanStack Query.

Conclusion: Using currently available widely accepted technologies; there are no dependencies required from experimental or proprietary systems to implement this proposed system.

4.2.2 Economic Feasibility

The costs of developing this platform will be negligible. Only free and open source tools are used in the development chain. A variety of cloud-hosting options, which provide low-cost hosting services for backend applications (Render) and frontend applications (Vercel) are also available. These service providers have free-tier services that would support an academic prototype. There are several monetization models that could be used by the platform owners to generate revenue from users who access or use the platform, including subscription based fees to vendors, transaction commission payments and targeted local advertising. This means there is a commercially sustainable route forward for the platform owners.

Conclusion: The project is economically viable at both the development and operational stages.

4.2.3 Operational Feasibility

The design of the system has an emphasis on user experience as its primary design goal. It follows a familiar pattern to e-commerce sites that customers are used to seeing in terms of interaction so that there will be very little, if any, need for the majority of users to learn anything new. The vendor's dashboard has been developed specifically with people who have limited or no computer knowledge in mind; it includes easy-to-follow steps when creating listings for products and managing inventory. The major operational issue with the system is getting vendors to use it regularly and consistently update their inventory levels. This problem is going to be solved by using automation to send notifications to the vendors when they make changes to their products, and implementing a simple and easy way to get vendors into the system quickly.
Conclusion: There will be very little training needed for either the customer or vendor to operate the system.

4.2.4 Time Feasibility

The project should be able to be completed in an academic semester. A single semester of work will be used for each phase of this project which includes:
Phase one – requirements analysis (one or two weeks)
Phase two – system design (two weeks)
Phase three – front-end and back end coding (six to eight weeks)
Phase four – integrating all aspects of the application with testing (two to three weeks)
Phase five – deploying the final version of the application (one week).
Conclusion: The project is achievable within the stipulated academic timeline.

4.2.5 Legal and Ethical Feasibility

User Data is treated by the System with regard to Data Minimization Principles. All Authentications are performed using Industry-Standard Security Practices. User Personal Data will be made available to Third Parties only after a user has given their express Consent. Ranking of Vendors/Products for this Platform is done fairly and non-discriminatorily

Conclusion: The system is legally and ethically feasible, contingent on proper implementation of data security and privacy controls.

4.3 Project Plan

Table 4.2: Phase-wise Project Development Plan

Phase	Description	Duration
Phase 1: Requirement Analysis	Identification of functional/non-functional requirements, stakeholder consultation, scope definition	1–2 weeks
Phase 2: System Design	Architecture design, ER diagram, UI wireframes, API specification	2 weeks
Phase 3: Development	Parallel frontend and backend implementation per modular design	6–8 weeks
Phase 4: Integration	API integration, end-to-end module connectivity, data flow validation	1–2 weeks
Phase 5: Testing	Unit, integration, system, and user acceptance testing	2 weeks
Phase 6: Deployment	Cloud deployment, environment configuration, documentation finalisation	1 week

Table 4.3: Risk Management Matrix

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Inaccurate real-time inventory data due to manual vendor input	Automated sync reminders, threshold-based alerts, vendor training
Low initial vendor adoption rate	Simplified onboarding UI, incentive-based early adoption programme
Third-party API usage limitations	Caching strategies, fallback mechanisms, rate limit monitoring
Performance degradation under high concurrent load	Cloud auto-scaling, database indexing, query optimisation

5. SOFTWARE REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

5.1 Introduction

The Software Requirements Specification (SRS), as part of the Software Requirements Analysis (SRA), will formally specify the functional, nonfunctional and interfacing requirements for the functionality in the FYP Platform. The SRS will be the contractual agreement between the development team and all other stakeholders regarding how the system should behave before it is implemented. All requirements specified in this document are in accordance with conventional standards used in the software engineering community using the IEEE 830 SRS document framework.

5.2 General Description

The FYP system is a web based client server, it has three primary layers of functionality: a front-end (presentation) using react.js and leaflet for mapping ; the back-end application logic using node.js and express.js; and the database (data storage/persistence) using mongoDB. The FYP also integrates services from outside as follows: geolocation api for location determination (the customer's device); leaflet to render maps in an interactive fashion; smtp to send otps and notifications to vendors via email.

The FYP provides three distinct types of users with different levels of authority to use the system: Customers – customers can browse products and get directions to vendors' locations; Vendors – vendors have ability to enter their own information/products and view their own sales/demand history through a separate vendor portal; Administrators – administrators have full control over all aspects of the system including verifying vendors, managing users etc.

Table 5.1: User Classes and Characteristics

User Class	Characteristics and Responsibilities
Customer	General users with minimal technical proficiency. Primary interactions: search, browse, compare, navigate, request.
Vendor	Shop owners managing product listings and inventory. Require guided interface for product management and analytics.
Administrator	System operators with full platform access. Responsible for vendor verification, user management, and content moderation.

5.3 Specific Requirements

5.3.1 Functional Requirements

The main features of the system can be categorized into "customer module" in order to make it easier to track how each function will be developed and tested.

In this section, the customer module is defined as follows:

Customer Module

- FR1. The system will provide customers with the ability to find products based on their names through the use of a full-text search interface.
- FR2. The system will show nearby vendors that have sold the product found by the customer along with the vendor's location relative to the customer's detected location.
- FR3. The system will provide customers with the option to filter their search results by price range, by radius of distance from the customer's current location, by categories of products and by the ratings given to the vendors selling those products.
- FR4. The system will display up-to-date availability information for the products being displayed as per the vendor's inventory data base.
- FR5. The system will show all prices available at all of the different vendors for a single item (product).
- FR6. The system will generate an interactive map showing where the vendors selling these items are located and also give users the option to navigate there
- FR7: The system shall allow customers to submit product requests for items not currently listed by nearby vendors.

Vendor Module

- FR8: The Vendor Registration Process will be performed via E-mail based One Time Password (OTP) Verification.
- FR9: Vendors will be able to create, Edit & Soft Delete Product Listings with Full Attribute Specification (Name, Price, Category, Description & Stock Quantity).
- FR10: Vendor Inventory Updates will Synchronise in Real-Time Across All Customer Facing Interfaces.

- FR11: Automated Notifications to Vendors will be Dispatched When Stock Levels Drop Below Configurable Thresholds.
- FR12: Vendors Will Be Notified of Elevated Demand Signals Derived From Customer Search Activity.
- FR13: An Analytics Dashboard will be Provided Displaying Search Trends, Demand Patterns & Inventory Performance Metrics.

Administrator Module

- FR14: The system shall have a method by which managers can approve/deny requests from vendors to register their company with the site.
- FR15: The system shall be able to handle creation and modification of products within categories/sub-categories.
- FR16: The system will provide management options to deactivate/lockout users/vendors.
- FR17: The system shall provide all platforms (site) analytical information on total number of registered users, active vendor count(s), and general search volume.

5.3.2 Non-Functional Requirements

Performance

- System will deliver search results in approximately 2-3 seconds during regular operation.
- Simultaneous users are expected to be able to utilize the API while making no less than 500 concurrent API calls at one time (under heavy load), without experiencing performance issues.

Security

- All authentications will be done using JWT Tokens and will have a configurable token expiration time along with an OTP based method for verifying user identity.
- Passwords will only be encrypted as bcrypt hashed passwords with a cost factor of at least 10.
- Role Based Access Control will deny privilege escalation on all API endpoints.

- All transmissions will use HTTPS.

Scalability and Reliability

- The system architecture shall support horizontal scaling through stateless API design.
- Database queries shall employ appropriate indexing strategies to maintain sub-200ms response times for common queries.
- The system shall achieve a minimum uptime of 99.5% in production deployment.

Usability

- Responsive Design: The interface will meet the requirements of responsive web design; this means that it will render properly on all screens, ranging from mobile devices with an approximately 320 pixel wide display to desktop computers using displays of approximately 1,440 pixels.
- Customer Search Workflow: The Customer Search Workflow should be able to be completed in no more than three user interactions.

6. DESIGN

6.1 System Architecture

The FYP Platform follows the Three-Tiered Client-Server Architecture paradigm. It includes the separation of the Presentation Logic, Application Logic, and Data Persistence as independent modules that can each be deployed independently and scaled separately. In order to provide a solid base for maintainability, testability and expandability, the architectural choice made here was good.

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────┐  PRESENTATION LAYER
│  React.js (Vite) | Tailwind CSS | React Router DOM │
│  TanStack Query | Leaflet Maps | Axios            │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────┘  ↓ HTTP REST API
                                (JSON)
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────┐  APPLICATION LAYER
│  Node.js | Express.js | RESTful API Routes        │
│  JWT Middleware | OTP Auth | RBAC | Nodemailer    │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────┘  ↓ Mongoose ODM
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────┐  DATA LAYER
│  MongoDB | Collections: Users|Products|Vendors|Orders │
```

Figure 6.1: Three-Tier System Architecture Diagram

6.2 Design Notations

6.2.1 Data Flow Diagrams (DFD)

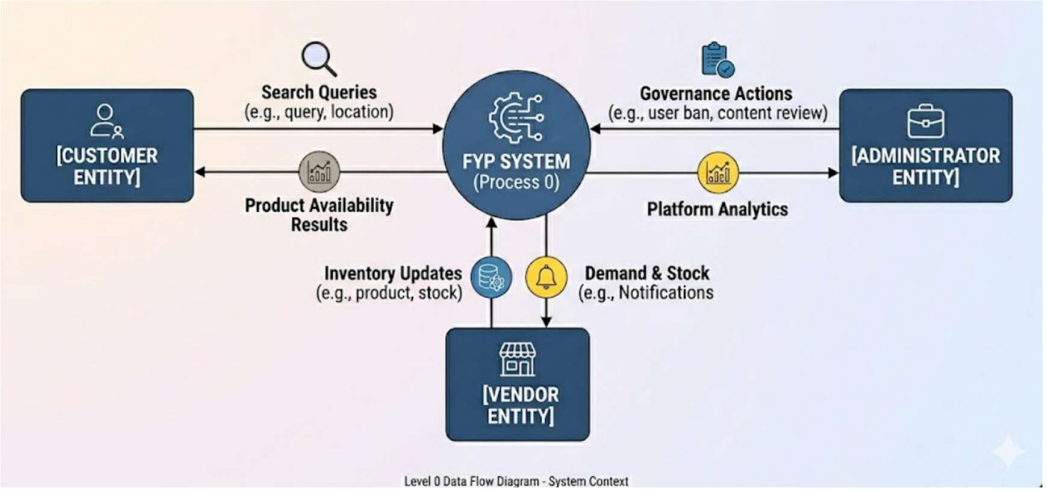

Figure 6.2: Level 0 Context Diagram (DFD) — FYP System

The FYP system at level 0 accepts searches and location information submitted by customers and responds with product availability. Vendors submit inventory updates to the system as well as receive demand and stock levels. Administrators submit governance requests for the platform as well as receive platform usage statistics.

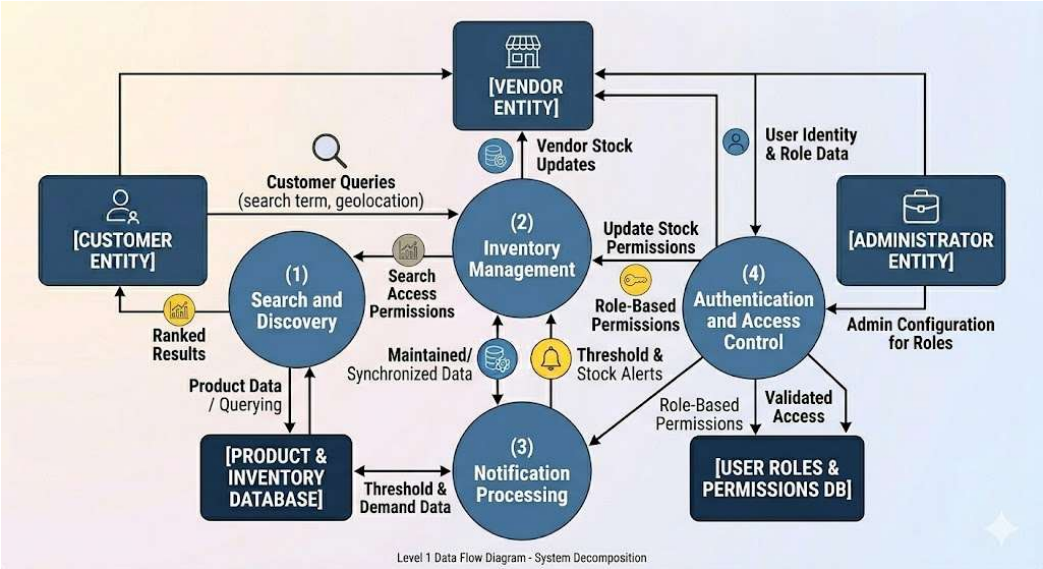

Figure 6.3: Level 1 DFD — Decomposed Process Flow

Level 1 of the system is made up of four major functions:
(1) Search & Discovery: Accepts customer inquiries. Queries a database of products and inventory. Filters by geo-location. Returns ranked results.
(2) Inventory Mgt.: Processes inventory data submitted by vendors. Maintains inventory data synchronized with vendor submissions.
(3) Notifications: Tracks inventory threshold, demand and supply. Sends alert to vendors when inventory or demand conditions are met.
(4) Auth & Access Control: Validates user ID. Applies role based permissions to each function within the system

6.2.2 Entity Relationship Diagram

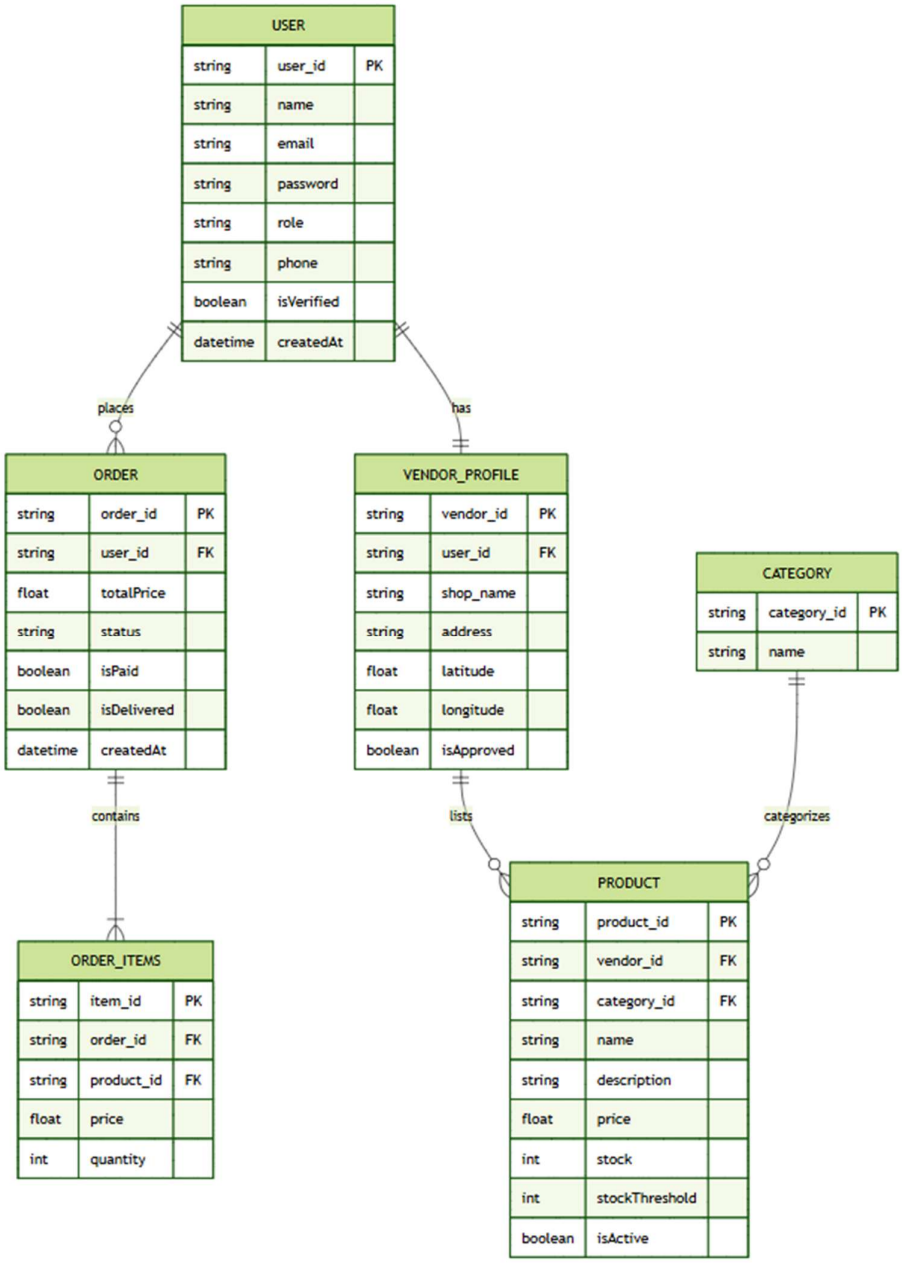

Figure 6.4: Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD) — FYP Database Schema

6.3 Detailed Module Design

6.3.1 Search and Discovery Module

The customer enters a Product Name in the search field of the Customer Interface. This input is passed as a query string to the Search Module. The Search Module performs a Full Text Search of the MongoDB Collection for Products, utilizing a Compound Index on the Product Name Field and Description Fields. The Search Module uses a Configurable Geolocation Radius (calculated using the Haversine Formula) to filter results based upon the Vendor Coordinates within the MongoDB Database and the Customers' current GPS location. The Filtered Result Set is then Sorted using a Composite Score derived from Distance and Price. Finally, the Sorted List of Vendors is returned along with the number of People at each Vendor Location via Mongoose's. populate() method.

6.3.2 Location and Geolocation Module

The geolocation module uses a call to the Navigator. Geolocation API to obtain the customer's location as determined by their device. This information is then sent along with every product search request made from that customer. Once received on the server side, this location information can be used to calculate the distance (in miles) of all vendors based upon the Latitude/Longitude value(s) for each vendor which have been pre-stored within the Vendor Collection. There is also a maxRadius parameter that can be set to filter-out vendors who are located further than an acceptable radius away from the customer. Leaflet.js is used to render the customers' viewable map (and support click throughs to vendor profile pages and/or product listing pages).

6.3.3 Inventory Management Module

The Inventory Module supplies vendors with an all-encompassing interface (CRUD) to manage their products. The Stock quantity of each item is stored within the product listing document as a field, and the Stock quantity is automatically updated in real-time using authenticated PUT API calls. On every stock quantity update, a Threshold Evaluation is performed. If the Quantity falls below the Minimum configured value, a notification is sent via the Notification Module.

6.3.4 Notification Module

The Notification Module functions as a Service that uses events from Inventory Updates and Demand Analytics Processing. As such, it generates emails to customers using Nodemailer and SMTP for Low Stock Alerts, High-Demand Signals, and Customer Product Requests. The notification records are stored in a separate MongoDB Collection allowing vendors to access them as needed and to perform audits.

6.4 Flowcharts

6.4.1 Product Search Flowchart

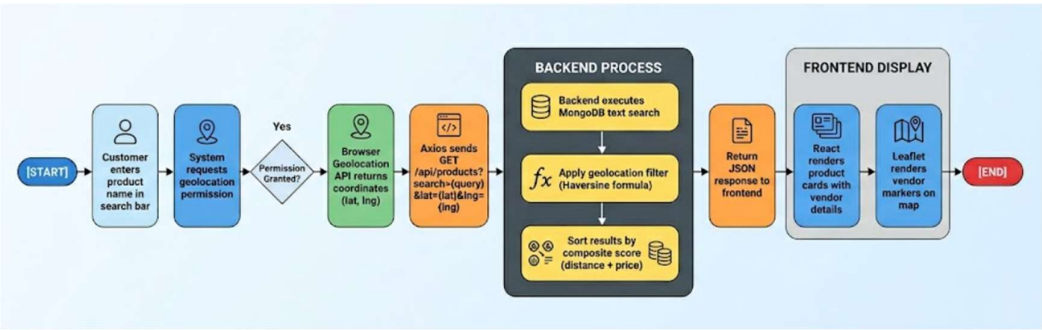

Figure 6.5: Product Search Flowchart

6.4.2 Inventory Alert Flowchart

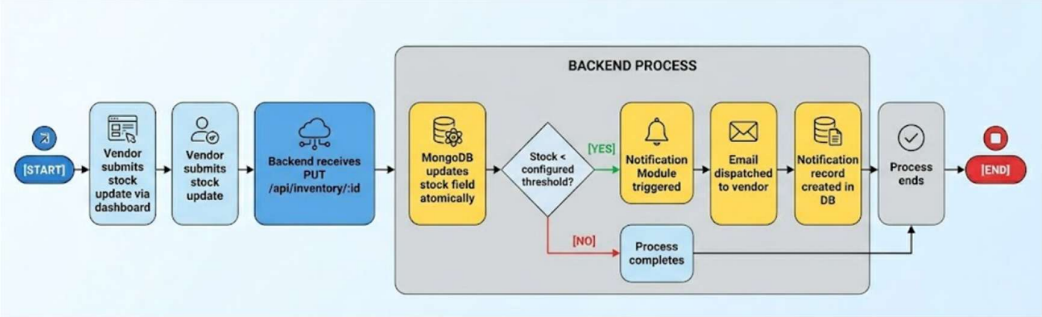

Figure 6.6: Inventory Alert System Flowchart

6.5 Pseudocode

6.5.1 Product Search Algorithm

```
FUNCTION searchProducts(query, userLat, userLng, maxRadius):
products ← MongoDB.textSearch(query)   results ← []   FOR EACH
product IN products:     dist ← haversine(userLat, userLng,
product.vendor.lat, product.vendor.lng)     IF dist ≤ maxRadius
AND product.stock > 0:       results.APPEND({ product,
distance: dist })   SORT results BY (price ASC, distance ASC)
RETURN results
```

6.5.2 Inventory Alert Algorithm

```
FUNCTION evaluateStock(productId, newStock):   UPDATE
Product[productId].stock ← newStock (atomic)   IF newStock <
STOCK_THRESHOLD:     notification ← buildAlert(productId,
"LOW_STOCK")     Email.send(vendor.email, notification)
DB.notifications.INSERT(notification)   IF
demandScore(productId) > DEMAND_THRESHOLD:
Email.send(vendor.email, buildAlert(productId, "HIGH_DEMAND"))
```

7. TESTING

7.1 Functional Testing

Functional testing is intended to prove how well a system works as it relates to what has been specified in the Software Requirements Analysis. The test cases developed are based upon the functional requirements (FR1- FR17). As such, all of the functional requirements have been covered completely.

Table 7.1: Functional Test Cases

ID	Feature	Input	Expected Output	Result	Req.
FT01	Product Search	Search: "Milk", Location: GPS enabled	List of nearby vendors stocking milk, sorted by distance	Pass	FR1-2
FT02	Location Filter	User location enabled, radius = 5km	Only vendors within 5km radius displayed	Pass	FR2
FT03	Price Comparison	Same product from 3 vendors	Products sorted by price ascending with vendor labels	Pass	FR5
FT04	Inventory Update	Vendor sets stock = 15	Stock updated in DB; customer view reflects change immediately	Pass	FR10
FT05	Low Stock Alert	Vendor sets stock = 3 (threshold = 5)	Email notification dispatched to vendor within 30 seconds	Pass	FR11
FT06	Product Request	Customer submits request for unavailable product	Request stored; nearby vendors receive notification	Pass	FR7
FT07	User Authentication	Valid email/password credentials	JWT token issued; user redirected to dashboard	Pass	FR8
FT08	Invalid Login	Incorrect password entered	HTTP 401 error; appropriate error message displayed	Pass	FR8
FT09	OTP Verification	Correct OTP submitted within 10 minutes	Account verified; isVerified flag set to true in DB	Pass	FR8
FT10	RBAC Enforcement	Customer attempts to access vendor dashboard API endpoint	HTTP 403 Forbidden returned; access denied	Pass	FR14

7.2 Structural Testing (White-Box Testing)

To test that all of the internal workings were correct in terms of algorithms, we performed structural tests for each of those parts. We tested all possible paths through code; we checked how our code behaved when it hit a boundary condition; and we verified that data transformations are being done correctly. Our main structural testing items included the Search Algorithm (the Haversine distance calculations and the search results ranking); the Inventory Threshold Logic (how this piece behaves when it hits exactly its threshold value); the Authentication Middleware (how this handles token expirations and rejects tokens which have been tampered with); and the Notification Trigger Logic (how concurrent updates affect the triggering logic).

Table 7.2: Structural Testing Summary

Component	Testing Approach	Outcome
Haversine distance function	Verified against known coordinate pairs with calculated distances	Accuracy ≤0.1km error
Inventory threshold logic	Tested at threshold, below threshold, and above threshold values	Alert triggered correctly
JWT authentication middleware	Expired, malformed, and valid token scenarios tested	All rejections handled correctly
Search ranking algorithm	Verified sort order with controlled price/distance test datasets	Results ordered correctly

7.3 Levels of Testing

7.3.1 Unit Testing

Each function or component (React) was individually tested. Utility functions for the backend (generation of OTPs, signing with JWT, hash of passwords, computation of Haversine) have been checked by input-bounded boundary tests as well as equivalence classes tests. In order to check that each frontend component correctly renders when presented with a variety of property settings, they are isolated and rendered via React Testing Library.

7.3.2 Integration Testing

The goal of integration tests is to validate the exchange of data between integrated modules. The main integration test cases executed are: search module — mongoDB (execution and filling of query; populating results); inventory module — notification module (triggering threshold & sending emails); authentication middleware —

protected api routes (enforcing access rights). Postman has been utilized to run the integration test suite on the production backend.

7.3.3 System Testing

End_to_end testing was conducted throughout each user journey for all roles. Customer role journey: Registration → one time password (otp) verification → login → product search → price compare → map navigation → product request. Vendor role journey: Registration → administrative approval → create/update product listings → modify existing inventory → receive notifications of new orders/pending shipments → review analytics.

7.3.4 User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

The User Acceptance Test (UAT) testing process used five customers and/or vendors in each test group. The participant completed pre-defined tasks on their own and provided qualitative feedback about the system. The key results from this test are that 90% of customers thought the Product Search Workflow was intuitive, and the Vendor Inventory Management tool would have minimal User Interface (UI) clarifications needed for new users.

7.3.5 Performance Testing

The performance of the front-end was assessed through Google Lighthouse as having achieved an overall performance rating of 88/100 for the product search page. Benchmarking of backend API's response time to simulate concurrent requests from Postman indicated that the search function provided responses in approximately 180 – 250 milliseconds (under typical loads) which satisfies our goal of providing responses in less than 300ms.

Overall Testing Conclusion:

The FYP Platform has demonstrated solid performance with regards to functional compliance, internally consistent algorithms and reasonable performance metrics. It is also important to note all key functionality has been confirmed. Thus it is both fit-for-purpose for evaluation by academics and/or demonstration of prototypes.

8. IMPLEMENTATION

8.1 Implementation of the Project

The Implementation Phase converted the System Design Specifications into a working Application using an iterative development process with each module developed, unit tested individually and then merged to create the overall system.

The Development process used the Separation of Concerns Principle (maintaining distinct layering for the Presentation Layer, Business Logic Layer, Data Access Layer) to ensure that there were clear boundaries between them.

Table 8.1: Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Frontend	React.js (Vite)	Component-based UI framework with fast hot module replacement
Frontend	Tailwind CSS	Utility-first CSS for responsive, consistent styling
Frontend	TanStack Query	Server state management, data fetching, caching, and synchronisation
Frontend	Leaflet.js	GIS-based interactive maps for vendor location discovery
Frontend	Axios	HTTP client for RESTful API communication with interceptors
Backend	Node.js + Express.js	Scalable server-side runtime and web framework for RESTful APIs
Database	MongoDB + Mongoose	Document-oriented NoSQL database with ODM for schema enforcement
Auth	JWT + bcrypt + OTP	Stateless session management, password hashing, identity verification
Notifications	Nodemailer (SMTP)	Email delivery for OTP, stock alerts, and demand notifications

The structure of the project was based on a total of six modules which were implemented in parallel depending upon dependency. These were the "Authentication Module" (user registration, OTP validation, JWT creation), the "Product and Search Module" (product searching by full-text search, geolocated product results that are ranked), the "Inventory Module", (CRUD for inventory items; inventory item tracking and monitoring thresholds); the "Notification Module", (dispatching email notifications and triggering events); the "Vendor Dashboard" (order management analytics); and the "Admin Panel" (approval of vendors; user management).

8.2 Conversion Plan

The Conversion Strategy will detail how the end-users are converted from using their manual product finding process to the Digital Product Finding Platform developed

within the FYP. It is planned that a phase based transition (conversion) will be implemented so that all processes can continue with minimal operational disruption whilst validating the functionality of the new system progressively through a real time operating environment.

Table 8.2: Phased Conversion Plan

Step	Description
1	Document and analyse the existing manual product discovery process to identify transition points and data migration requirements.
2	Deploy the system in a limited pilot environment with a selected cohort of vendors and customers in a defined geographic area.
3	Onboard vendors incrementally, providing guided training sessions for product listing and inventory management.
4	Monitor system performance, collect user feedback, and iterate on UI and functionality based on real-world usage.
5	Expand the platform to additional geographic areas and vendor categories following successful pilot validation.
6	Full regional rollout with complete vendor coverage and public-facing marketing campaign.

8.3 Post-Implementation and Software Maintenance

The above describes how the four categories of maintenance are defined as follows:

- Corrective Maintenance (CM) refers to the process of identifying and fixing errors with the software that occur after it has been deployed. Examples include analyzing why an application crashed, reviewing logs for application or service errors, and deploying hotfixes to resolve these issues.
- Adaptive Maintenance (AM) addresses modifications to the system made necessary due to changes in its outside technical environment. This includes updating third-party APIs; migrating libraries from one version to another; and implementing updates to cloud services supporting the application.
- Perfective Maintenance (PM) refers to enhancements to both function and performance of the application as a result of feedback received from users, along with insights gained by using metrics and analytics about how users use the application. These enhancements can be anything from making improvements to the User Interface (UI), enhancing a search algorithm used within the application, or adding new features to a Dashboard.
- Preventative Maintenance (PM) represents all actions taken proactively to ensure the long-term health/stability of the application. Examples include validating indexes created on databases, applying security patches, verifying backups, and auditing dependencies.

To assist in performing PM, a monitor/observability stack will also be built utilizing cloud-based tools to provide structure for collecting, reporting, and alerting on structured logs related to performance metrics, application errors, etc., enabling proactive maintenance of the application.

9. PROJECT LEGACY

9.1 Current Status of the Project

The FYP platform has reached MVP status in that it includes all of its core functional requirements which have been both tested and validated. All major modules are functioning within a local test server environment, which provides a solid base for both academic assessment and prototype demonstrations; additionally, it will provide a good starting point for future commercial development.

All completed aspects of the application include the entire authentication process (registration, OTP verification, JWT based session management), a product search function that incorporates geolocation to filter products by location, a vendor's inventory management along with low stock alerts, a Leaflet based interactive map to view vendors' locations on the map, a dashboard to track analytics from each vendor, and finally a RESTful API layer with full documentation at every endpoint, including role-based access control throughout the three types of users.

9.2 Remaining Areas of Concern

Technical and operational issues must be addressed when transitioning the MVP from prototype to full-scale production.
Technical issues include:

- Real-time inventory accuracy: Manual vendor initiated stock updates are currently used. Point of sale inventory synchronization through IOT will provide accurate real time inventory updates automatically, thus removing the reliance on vendors.
- Scalability under high loads: Current deployment is a single instance. Horizontal scalability (load balancing, stateless api's using shared session storage) will need to be incorporated to support large number of users. Geolocation accuracy: Urban areas have poor GPS signal strength and accuracy. IP based geolocation services may be required as a redundant service if gps does not work properly.

- Security hardening: Additional security features that will need to be included in order to allow a public production deployment include; Rate limiting on authentication, Input validation/sanitization via helmet.js and an official security review before release.Operational issues also exist and relate to vendor adoption:
- Vendor Onboarding Experience: Vendors must have an easy way to onboard in order to sustain their participation in the program. This could include a mobile first app due to the preference for mobile devices by many small retailers.

9.3 Technical and Managerial Lessons Learnt

9.3.1 Technical Lessons

The project demonstrated significant learning of multiple technical areas. The development and deployment of a RESTful API using JWT authentication expanded the students' practical experience with stateless authentication protocols and their resultant security ramifications. The use of MongoDB and Mongoose to build the backend reinforced both the theoretical and practical differences in relational (e.g. SQL) versus document-oriented (e.g. NoSQL/MongoDB) modeling techniques along with the trade-off considerations associated with designing schemas for varying types of products within a single database. Finally, incorporating location based services into an end-to-end web application increased the students' proficiency in all aspects of working with spatial data including the use of the Haversine Formula for calculating distances as well as performing query operations on geo-spatial data at both the server side as well as client side utilizing mapping libraries.

9.3.2 Managerial Lessons

The project highlighted the necessity of thorough initial gathering of all necessary requirements before beginning the development process, as it is much more expensive to rectify ambiguities in requirements discovered when developing software, rather than when analyzing. The phased nature of the development allowed for the complex elements involved to be managed effectively. Early identification of possible areas where the system could fail—i.e. dependency on third party vendor to provide accurate data—through active risk management strategies enabled proactive design of compensatory strategies (e.g., automated reminder systems, threshold alerting systems)

to reduce the risk. Additionally, ongoing refinements to the User Interface (UI), based upon the results from usability testing and acceptance testing (UAT), illustrated that a user centric design philosophy can be an effective strategy in realizing operational feasibility.

10. USER MANUAL (HELP GUIDE)

10.1 Introduction

This User Guide will provide a complete set of step-by-step instructions on how to use the Find Your Product (FYP)—Location Based Local Product Discovery System. The guide is organized by user type; as such there are specific sections for Customers, Suppliers/Vendors and Administrators. It has been written with users that do not have technical backgrounds in mind. All of the major workflows available through this system will be covered in the guide.

10.2 System Requirements

Table 10.1: System Requirements

Requirement Type	Specification
Hardware	Smartphone, tablet, or computer with internet connectivity; GPS-enabled device recommended for location features
Browser	Google Chrome (v100+), Mozilla Firefox (v95+), Microsoft Edge (v100+); JavaScript must be enabled
Internet	Stable internet connection (minimum 1 Mbps); 4G/LTE or Wi-Fi recommended for map features
Location	Browser location permission must be granted for proximity-based search features

10.3 Customer User Guide

10.3.1 Account Registration and Login

Navigate to the FYP Platform in your web browser. At the Home Page, click on "Register" for creating an account. Create your account by entering your Full Name, Email Address, and a Secure Password. You will receive a 6 Digit One Time Passcode (OTP) via email to your registered email ID. The passcode needs to be entered on the Verification Screen within Ten Minutes from receiving it. After verifying yourself, use "Login" option and then enter your registered email id & password.

10.3.2 Searching for a Product

Go to the Home Page (or Search Page) and type in the Name of the Product you are Looking for into the Search Bar. Once Prompted, Give Permission to Access Your Location so that it can Find Vendors Near You. Then Press the "Search" Button or Press Enter. The system will display a list of nearby vendors currently stocking the product,

sorted by proximity. Each result card displays the product name, vendor store name, current price, stock availability, and approximate distance from your location.

10.3.3 Comparing Prices and Viewing the Map

On the search results page you can see all of the products that have been found by your search along with their price. If there is more than one seller who has an item you want to purchase, then you can look at the price they have for it in order to make a decision. Using the Map View button will take you to an interactive map which includes pin markers for each vendor's location. When you click on a pin marker, you'll be able to view the vendor's information as well as a link to help navigate to their store.

10.3.4 Requesting an Unavailable Product

If there are no products in your immediate area that meet your needs, then click on the "Request this Product" link at the bottom of each page of the search result listings. Enter the full name of the product as well as any other information such as your preferred quantity, how soon you need it. Once you have submitted the request for your product(s), all vendors within your immediate area will be notified.

10.4 Vendor User Guide

10.4.1 Vendor Registration and Approval

Navigate to the website. Go through register as a vendor. Fill out the vendor application by providing your store name, address, phone number, contact information and your product categories. Click submit so that it can be reviewed by admin. Once you have received approval on your account via email, sign into your account with the user ID and password you created during registration.

10.4.2 Managing Product Listings

Navigate to the Products section of the vendor dashboard. Click the "Add New Product" button to begin adding your new listing. Once in the product creation screen enter a title for your product as well as a detailed description. Next select the appropriate category for your product. Next you need to set the price and enter how much inventory you have currently available. If desired you can add an image of the product. After all fields are populated, click save and the item is instantly live. To make changes to a product listing

that already exists, locate the listing's product card and click the edit option. The deactivate feature allows you to remove products from search results while still keeping them active (live) in your store.

10.4.3 Managing Inventory and Alerts

You can update inventory quantities by product in the Inventory area of your dashboard. When a product's quantity is lower than the minumum you've set up (the default is 5 units), the system sends you an automated e-mail alert. You may also adjust that minimum separately for each item.The Demand Alerts section will notify you when a product you stock is experiencing elevated search activity from customers in your area.

10.5 Administrator Guide

Admins have a unique admin login portal to enter into the platform. From this admin dashboard admins will be able to review/approve all pending vendor registration requests as well as manage their categories in the taxonomic system of products; view overall statistics of the platform (users, active vendors, searches); and also flag/report content that may violate terms of service. Also, from the vendor management section admins are able to suspend/reactivate vendor accounts. And, from user management, admins can review/modify user accounts.

10.6 Troubleshooting Guide

Table 10.2: Common Issues and Resolutions

Issue	Resolution
Location not detected / no nearby results	Ensure browser location permission is enabled. On mobile, confirm GPS is active. Try refreshing the page.
OTP not received	Check your spam/junk folder. OTPs expire after 10 minutes; use the Resend OTP option if necessary.
Login failure despite correct credentials	Confirm your account has been OTP-verified. Use the Forgot Password feature to reset if necessary.
Product search returns no results	Verify product name spelling. Try broader search terms. Expand the search radius in filter settings.
Map not loading	Ensure a stable internet connection. Disable browser extensions that may block map resources. Try a different browser.
Inventory updates not reflecting	Refresh the page. If the issue persists, clear browser cache and log in again.

11. SYSTEM SNAPSHOTS

11.1 System Snapshots

The following system snapshots illustrate the key interfaces of the FYP platform. Screenshots should be inserted below each caption in the final submitted document.

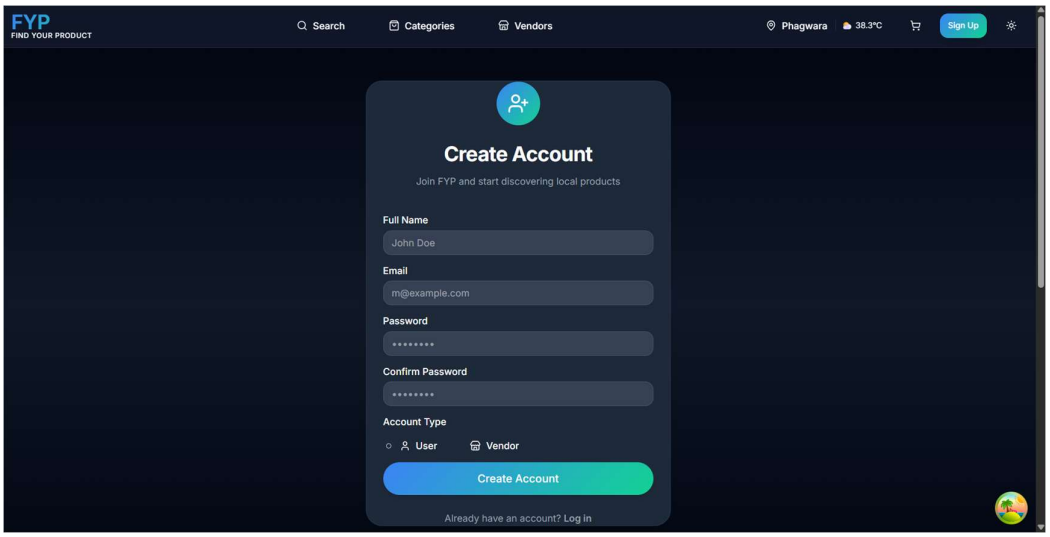

Figure 11.1: Customer Login and Registration Page

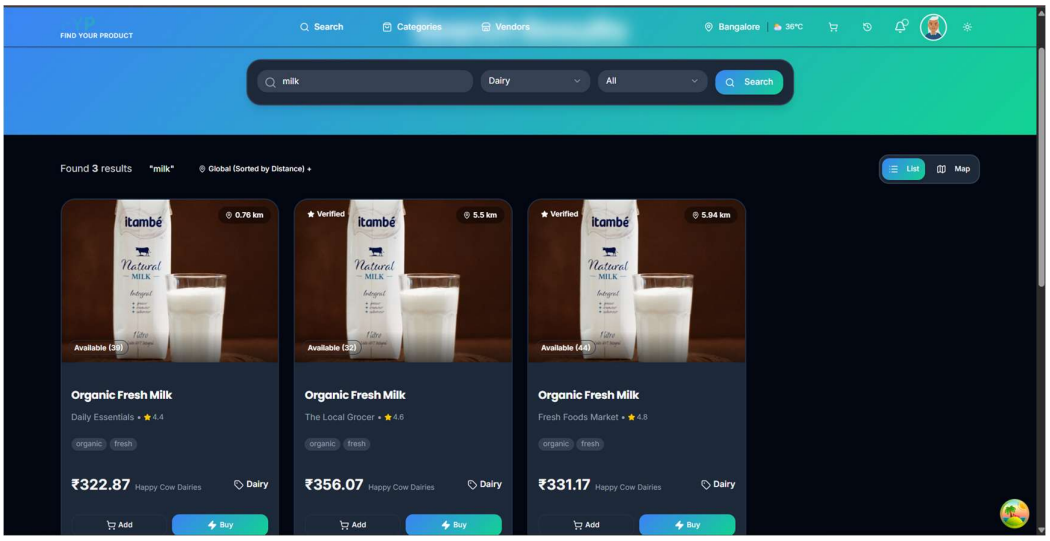

Figure 11.2: Product Search Results Page with Distance and Price Information

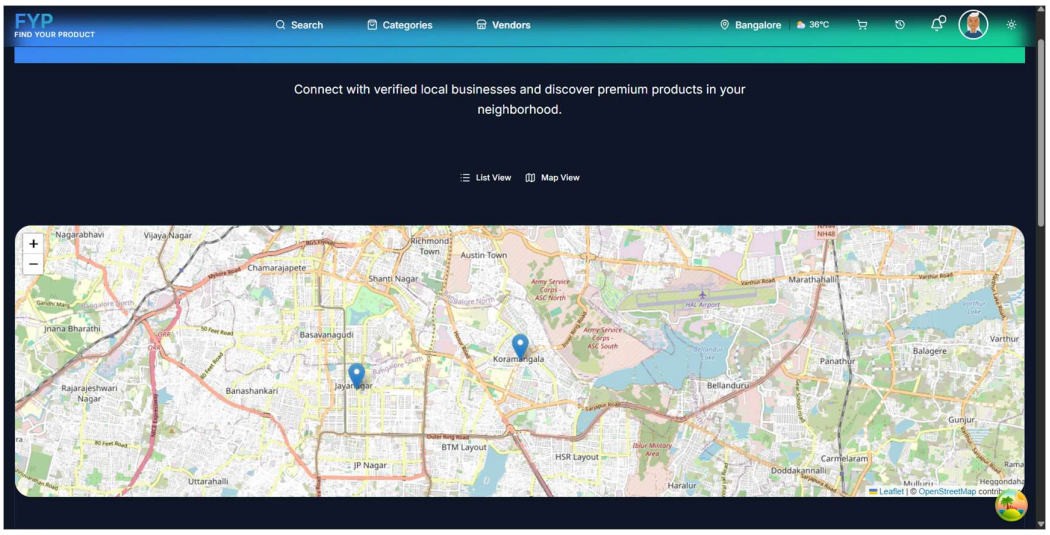

Figure 11.3: Interactive Vendor Location Map

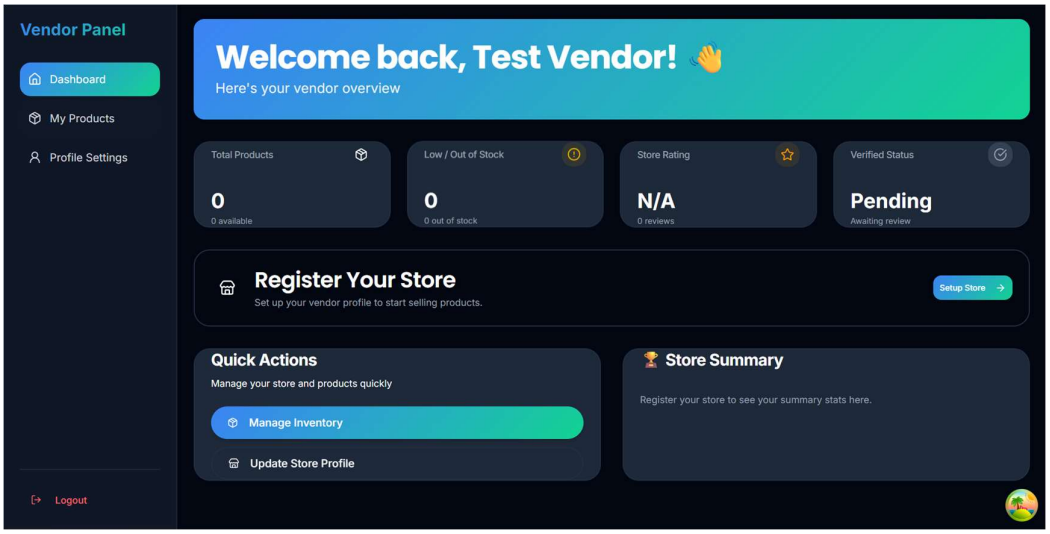

Figure 11.4: Vendor Dashboard — Inventory Management Interface

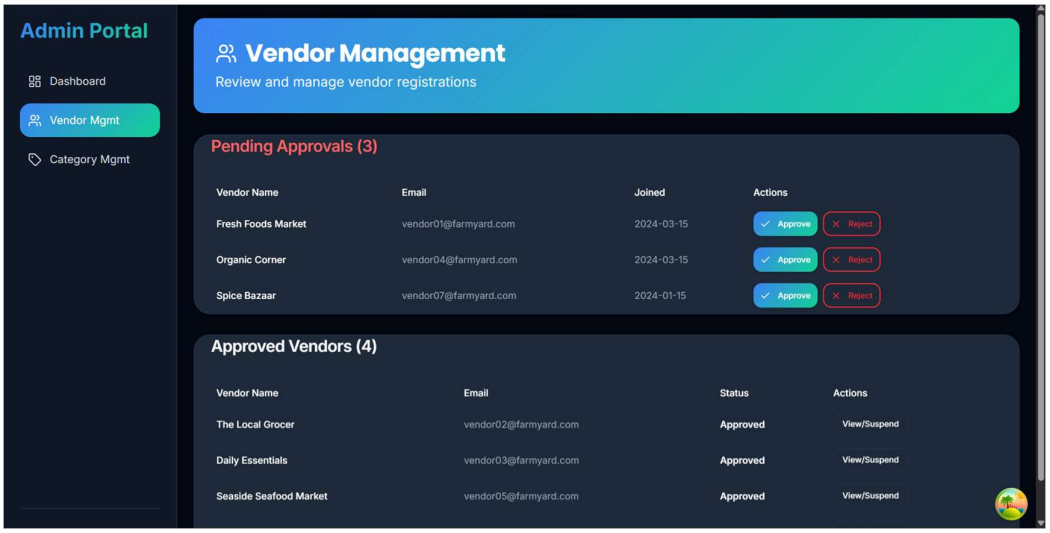

Figure 11.5: Administrator Panel — Vendor Approval Interface

12. FUTURE SCOPE AND ENHANCEMENTS

The current MVP implementation presents a well-established, tested base for the creation of a commercial product. Below is an outline of the next steps as per priority level along with their respective technological paths and anticipated effects:

Table 12.1: Future Development Roadmap

Pri.	Enhancement	Technology	Expected Impact
P1	Payment Gateway Integration	Razorpay / Stripe	Enables real transactions; critical for commercial launch
P1	Real-time Push Notifications	WebSockets / Socket.io	Instant order and inventory alerts for vendors and customers
P1	IoT-based Inventory Sync	POS API / RFID integration	Eliminates manual inventory entry; ensures real-time accuracy
P2	AI-Powered Recommendations	TensorFlow.js / Python ML API	Personalised product suggestions to increase conversion rate
P2	Mobile Application	React Native + Expo	Native iOS/Android apps for wider consumer market reach
P2	Vendor-Customer Messaging	Socket.io + MongoDB	Direct communication channel for pre-purchase queries
P3	Review and Rating System	MongoDB embedded subdocuments	Social proof mechanism to increase purchase confidence
P3	Multilingual Support	i18next / react-i18next	Regional language support to expand rural and semi-urban reach
P4	Progressive Web App (PWA)	Vite PWA Plugin + Service Workers	Offline capability and device installation for improved accessibility

13. CONCLUSION

Find your product (FYP) – location based product discovery for locally made products & inventory is a technically advanced response to an existing issue within the local retail commerce ecosystem that has been documented and proven persistent over time. In effect, it connects customers with product-seeking intent to their local inventory holding retailers through intelligent search & display of inventory availability. This provides tangible value to both sides of the marketplace transaction; as customers benefit from dramatically reduced search times & enhanced price transparency, while retailers gain digital exposure, tools for intelligently managing inventory, data driven insights on demand for previously unavailable small retail operators.

This project demonstrates mastery of full stack web development practices using contemporary methods including designing restful apis utilizing Node.js/Express.js, document oriented databases (mongodb), reactive frontend architecture (TanStack Query/React.js), geolocation integration (Leaflet), multi layered security implementation (bcrypt password hashing/JWT authentication/OTP verification/role based access control). Furthermore, industry standard tooling were used throughout the project (zod schema validation/tailwind CSS/Vite) ensuring the platform was developed using modern professional standards & will remain maintainable and scalable.

The FYP Platform addresses an authentic socio-economic issue, namely the exclusion of the majority of small local retailers from the new digital economy which has fundamentally changed commercial processes on a national and international level. The FYP Platform provides local retailers with a simple-to-use, easy-to-access online presence as well as tools for managing their stock levels and understanding their customers' purchasing trends, thereby promoting a more equitable and inclusive retail environment.

The FYP System was tested using a formal multi-stage testing program. It was shown to be functionally compliant, behave appropriately (algorithmically), and display satisfactory performance characteristics. Testing demonstrated that the FYP Platform met all usability standards for both the customer and vendor users. A comprehensive,

logical plan for future developments of the FYP Platform has also been developed by the development team. This includes payment gateway integration; use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) for recommending products to consumers; real-time communication between vendors and customers; and creating a mobile application version of the FYP Platform. The plan clearly defines how the FYP Platform can evolve from its current Minimum Viable Product (MVP) to a viable commercial product.

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